

SOCIALISM, FASCISM, ANARCHISM AND GANDHISM

UPSC PRELIMS + GS MAINS | PRIMARY HOME: GS-II CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATIONS

Continuous core-first rail | Advanced enrichment stays subordinate to the GS core

1 ORIGIN AND DATED RAIL

|              |                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1756-1836    | William Godwin                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 1772-1823    | David Ricardo                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 1793         | His Enquiry Concerning Political Justice                                                                                                                                           |
| 1793         | Godwin himself in his essay Enquiry Concerning Political Justice                                                                                                                   |
| 1806-56      | Then Max Stirner                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 1809-82      | Charles Darwin                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 1814-76      | Mikhail Bakunin                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1820-1903    | Herbert Spencer                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1825-64      | Ferdinand Lassalle                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 1828-1910    | Leo Tolstoy                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 1842-1921    | Peter Kropotkin                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1845         | German philosopher, in The Ego and his Own                                                                                                                                         |
| 1847-1922    | George Sorel                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 1850-1932    | Eduard Bernstein                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 1854-1939    | Karl Kautsky                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 1856-1950    | George Bernard Shaw                                                                                                                                                                |
| 1858-1943    | Beatrice Webb                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 1858-1932    | Graham Wallas                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 1859-1947    | Sydney Webb                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 1859-1943    | Sidney Olivier                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 1869-1948    | Mahatma Gandhi                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 1879-1940    | Leon Trotsky                                                                                                                                                                       |
| MECHANISM    | Chronology fixes what each named work actually changed, so the argument cannot slide into a vague rise-and-fall story.                                                             |
| TRAP / LIMIT | Socialism is just another word for Marxism -> Gauba treats socialism as a wider family including evolutionary, Fabian, revisionist, syndicalist and other variants. (PDF pp.55-63) |
| ANSWER LINE  | Socialism broadens the anti-capitalist field beyond Marxism and asks how equality can be secured through public control of production. (PDF pp.55-56)                              |

2 CHAPTER SPINE, STEP BY STEP

|              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Gauba first defines socialism by its aim of public control of major means of production for the public interest. (PDF p.55)</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● He then distinguishes evolutionary socialism from revolutionary socialism: the former compromises with capitalism through democratic reform, while the latter seeks total transformation through revolution. (PDF p.56)</li></ul>                                                                                                                                 |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● On fascism, Gauba narrates its origin under Mussolini, its opposition to liberalism and Marxism alike, its distorted borrowing from Idealism, and its spread (partial, book-period) to Nazi Germany, Franco's Spain and, with weaker parallels, Japan. (PDF pp.64-65)</li></ul>                                                                                   |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● He explains fascism as a reaction against democracy, socialism and communism, built on hierarchy over equality, the leader/single-party state over pluralism, myth/faith over reason, and extreme nationalism aiming at homogeneity rather than the liberal ideal of human equality. (PDF pp.66-69)</li></ul>                                                     |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Gauba also frames fascism as counter-revolutionary: it stripped capitalism of democratic and welfare-oriented restraints and left the masses without rights or safeguards. Separately, he characterizes fascism as militarist and imperialist; linking these features into one economic causal claim would require further argument. (PDF pp.65, 67-70)</li></ul> |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● He closes the theme with liberal and Marxist critiques of fascism and a firm conclusion that fascism is a "sick mental and political attitude" that curbs liberty and equality and distorts justice, not a genuine alternative political theory. (PDF pp.71-73)</li></ul>                                                                                         |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● On anarchism, Gauba argues that the target is coercive state authority, not all forms of coordination or moral obligation. (PDF pp.73-74)</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● On Gandhism, Gauba reconstructs politics as inseparable from ethics, means as inseparable from ends, and non-violence as the path to swaraj and social reconstruction. (PDF pp.78-81)</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                   |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Gandhi's classless ideal rests on trusteeship, bread labour, dignity of labour and moral self-discipline rather than violent class conflict. (PDF pp.81-83)</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| MECHANISM    | The spine is the order in which the source itself develops the argument; reproducing it keeps the answer sequenced rather than listed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| TRAP / LIMIT | Fascism and socialism are both "collectivist," so they belong together -> Gauba is explicit that fascism rejects equality and substitutes hierarchy, while socialism (in all its variants) seeks equality through public control; the two stand for opposite social values despite both criticizing unregulated capitalism. (PDF pp.55-56, 66)                                                            |
| ANSWER LINE  | Socialism: ownership or control of the means of production by the community or public authority in the interest of all. (PDF p.55)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

3 ILLUSTRATIONS ATTACHED TO THE CLAIMS THEY SUPPORT

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Fabianism uses the already existing democratic state as an</b><br>Fabianism uses the already existing democratic state as an instrument of reform instead of destroying it first. (PDF pp.57-58)                                                                                                   | <b>Mussolini's dismantling of Italy's parliamentary parties into</b><br>Mussolini's dismantling of Italy's parliamentary parties into "the" party, and his conversion of the premiership into "head of the government," illustrates the leader principle in practice. (PDF p.67)        |
| <b>Fascist states brought the press, radio, publishing and</b><br>Fascist states brought the press, radio, publishing and cinema under government control and subordinated even the judiciary to fascist ideals, illustrating the totalitarian reach of the leader-led single-party state. (PDF p.68) | <b>Proudhon's model imagines producers' associations linked by a</b><br>Proudhon's model imagines producers' associations linked by a federal principle and supported by a mutual credit bank. (PDF p.75)                                                                               |
| <b>Gandhi's bread labour asks every person to perform physical</b><br>Gandhi's bread labour asks every person to perform physical labour so that society restores dignity of labour and weakens class hierarchy. (PDF p.82)                                                                           | <b>A safe answer example is to contrast class cooperation</b><br>A safe answer example is to contrast class cooperation through trusteeship, totalitarian hierarchy through fascism, and class conflict through revolution as three rival responses to the same capitalist crisis       |
| MECHANISM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Examples are evidence only when the answer states what they prove and where they stop proving it.                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| TRAP / LIMIT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Fascism is a coherent political philosophy like liberalism or Marxism -> Gauba states fascism wove unrelated principles into an incoherent whole to meet political exigencies and never developed a consistent theory; it belongs to the study of "political pathology." (PDF pp.64-65) |
| ANSWER LINE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Socialism vs Marxism: socialism is a wider family. Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution. (PDF pp.55-63)                                                                                                   |

4 COMPARISON MATRIX

| Dimension             | Democratic / evolutionary socialism                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Fascism                                                                                                            | Anarchism                                                                                    | Gandhism                                                                                                |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Aim                   | Social justice through public control and democratic reform. (PDF pp.55-56)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Concentration of power in a supreme leader/single party to serve national and elite interest. (PDF pp.66-67)       | Stateless order without coercive authority. (PDF pp.73-74)                                   | Ethical self-rule, non-violence and classless social harmony. (PDF pp.78-83)                            |
| Method                | Parliament, reform, planning, unions, social conscience. (PDF pp.56-59)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Single-party dictatorship, propaganda/myth, suppression of rival parties and unions. (PDF pp.67-70)                | Voluntary association; some schools use insurrection, others peaceful action. (PDF pp.74-77) | Satyagraha, ahimsa, moral persuasion, bread labour. (PDF pp.79-82)                                      |
| View of state         | Instrument of reform. (PDF pp.57-60)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | State as an end in itself; individual reduced to a means with no independent rights. (PDF p.66)                    | Coercive authority to be abolished. (PDF pp.73-78)                                           | Soulless coercive machine that should become redundant in a self-regulated society. (PDF p.82)          |
| Equality vs hierarchy | Seeks socio-economic equality through public control. (PDF pp.55-56)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Rejects equality; substitutes hierarchy culminating in the leader's will as law. (PDF p.66)                        | Rejects coercive hierarchy of the state, though authority of experts may remain. (PDF p.74)  | Seeks equality through trusteeship and dignity of labour rather than coercive levelling. (PDF pp.81-82) |
| Violence/war          | Prefers peaceful, constitutional means                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Glorifies militarism, imperialism and war as instruments of national policy. (PDF p.65)                            | Varies by school; not uniformly violent. (PDF pp.74-77)                                      | Ahimsa (non-violence) is non-negotiable. (PDF pp.79-81)                                                 |
| Technology / economy  | Accepts modern productive organization but regulates it                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Leaves capitalist production concentrated in fewer hands, stripped of democratic/welfare restraint. (PDF pp.67-68) | Varies by school                                                                             | Prefers simple technology and production by the masses over mass production. (PDF p.81)                 |
| MECHANISM             | Running the comparison on shared axes converts a description into an adjudication.                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                    |                                                                                              |                                                                                                         |
| TRAP / LIMIT          | Mussolini's Italy and Hitler's Germany were identical -> Gauba treats Nazism as fascism's chief variant sharing many features (leader principle, single party, anti-liberal/anti-Marxist stance) but adding a distinct racist doctrine that Italian fascism did not centre in the same way. (PDF pp.64, 69) |                                                                                                                    |                                                                                              |                                                                                                         |
| ANSWER LINE           | Fabianism uses the already existing democratic state as an instrument of reform instead of destroying it first. (PDF pp.57-58)                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                    |                                                                                              |                                                                                                         |

5 EXAMINER TRAP FIREWALL

|              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TRAP         | Socialism is just another word for Marxism                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| REPAIR       | Gauba treats socialism as a wider family including evolutionary, Fabian, revisionist, syndicalist and other variants. (PDF pp.55-63)                                                                                                                                 |
| TRAP         | Fascism and socialism are both "collectivist," so they belong together                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| REPAIR       | Gauba is explicit that fascism rejects equality and substitutes hierarchy, while socialism (in all its variants) seeks equality through public control; the two stand for opposite social values despite both criticizing unregulated capitalism. (PDF pp.55-56, 66) |
| TRAP         | Fascism is a coherent political philosophy like liberalism or Marxism                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| REPAIR       | Gauba states fascism wove unrelated principles into an incoherent whole to meet political exigencies and never developed a consistent theory; it belongs to the study of "political pathology." (PDF pp.64-65)                                                       |
| TRAP         | Mussolini's Italy and Hitler's Germany were identical                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| REPAIR       | Gauba treats Nazism as fascism's chief variant sharing many features (leader principle, single party, anti-liberal/anti-Marxist stance) but adding a distinct racist doctrine that Italian fascism did not centre in the same way. (PDF pp.64, 69)                   |
| TRAP         | Anarchism means chaos                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| REPAIR       | Gauba says most anarchists accept rational expert authority and moral authority of democratic collective decisions. (PDF p.74)                                                                                                                                       |
| TRAP         | Gandhi wanted no social norms at all                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| REPAIR       | His stateless ideal depends on truth, non-violence, self-discipline and moral responsibility. (PDF pp.79-83)                                                                                                                                                         |
| TRAP         | Gandhi and Marx are basically the same because both mention classless society                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| REPAIR       | Gauba's comparison shows deep differences on religion, technology, class conflict, state and method. (PDF pp.82-83)                                                                                                                                                  |
| MECHANISM    | Each pair is a tested misreading followed by the exact repair the source supports.                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| TRAP / LIMIT | Anarchism means chaos -> Gauba says most anarchists accept rational expert authority and moral authority of democratic collective decisions. (PDF p.74)                                                                                                              |
| ANSWER LINE  | Use Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md for the ideology matrix comparing socialism, fascism, anarchism and Gandhism                                                                                                                                             |

6 OWNERSHIP BOUNDARIES AND CROSS-LINKS

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>THIS TOPIC OWNS</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Named additions strengthening socialism, anarchism and Gandhism as independently comparative doctrines (Sydney Webb, Sorel, Tolstoy, Sarvodaya) and the liberty-equality-state-property synthesis are reconstructed independently in §§12-13 of this file, so this Basic file is self-sufficient for an unfamiliar 10/15-mark question. Read the deeper companion at Political-Theory/advanced/05_Socialism-Fascism-Anarchism-and-Gandhism.md only for Advanced enrichment beyond a core GS answer (extra comparative matrices and answer-engine prompts)</li><li>- Use Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md for the ideology matrix comparing socialism, fascism, anarchism and Gandhism</li><li>- Use Political-Theory/README.md for the module map and for locating future state, justice and democracy continuities</li><li>- Indian constitutional welfare arrangements belong to Polity/advanced/08_Directive-Principles.md, not to this theory file</li><li>- Conservatism is not part of Gauba's PDF pp.55-83 range but is reconstructed in full in §22 of this file (Burke, Oakeshott; the four pillars, the strands, objections/repplies and the comparison with Fabian and Gandhian change), so a question naming conservatism alongside socialism, anarchism or Gandhism can be answered from this Basic file alone. Market-liberal content (Hayek, Friedman, Nozick) stays in Political-Theory/basic/03_Liberalism-and-Neoliberalism.md - see §22.6 for why filing it under conservatism is a misclassification</li></ul> | <b>DELEGATED OR EXCLUDED</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- For Gandhian philosophical depth, use Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Caste-Gandhi-Ambedkar.md and Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Social-Political-Ideals.md</li><li>- For totalitarianism as a broader concept alongside the "end of ideology" debate, see Political-Theory/basic/02_Ideology-and-End-of-Ideology.md</li></ul> |
| MECHANISM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Syllabus boundary discipline prevents a conceptual answer from being marked down as off-topic.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| TRAP / LIMIT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Gandhi wanted no social norms at all -> His stateless ideal depends on truth, non-violence, self-discipline and moral responsibility. (PDF pp.79-83)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| ANSWER LINE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Axis - Democratic/evolutionary socialism - Fascism - Anarchism - Gandhism                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

7 REVISION CAPSULE AND ANSWER SPINE

|              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Define socialism first as social ownership/control for public interest. (PDF p.55)</li></ul>                                                                                                             |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Distinguish democratic/evolutionary from Marxist/revolutionary socialism. (PDF p.56)</li></ul>                                                                                                           |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Define fascism as an incoherent, leader-led, single-party totalitarian doctrine that rejects liberalism, Marxism and democracy through extreme nationalism, hierarchy and myth. (PDF pp.64-69)</li></ul> |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Use Mussolini and Hitler as the two chief historical instances, noting Nazism's added racist doctrine. (PDF pp.64, 69)</li></ul>                                                                         |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Close fascism with Gauba's appraisal: a political pathology and "sick mental attitude," not a genuine theory, criticized by both liberals and Marxists. (PDF pp.71-73)</li></ul>                         |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Define anarchism as opposition to coercive state authority, not to all order. (PDF pp.73-74)</li></ul>                                                                                                   |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Use Proudhon, Kropotkin and Bakunin as the three clean anarchist anchors. (PDF pp.74-76)</li></ul>                                                                                                       |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Explain Gandhi through ethics in politics, ahimsa, satyagraha, trusteeship and bread labour. (PDF pp.79-82)</li></ul>                                                                                    |
|              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● End with the Marx-Gandhi contrast on class conflict, technology, religion and the state. (PDF pp.82-83)</li></ul>                                                                                        |
| MECHANISM    | The capsule is the last-minute recall rail; it should be reproducible in under two minutes.                                                                                                                                                      |
| TRAP / LIMIT | Gandhi and Marx are basically the same because both mention classless society -> Gauba's comparison shows deep differences on religion, technology, class conflict, state and method. (PDF pp.82-83)                                             |
| ANSWER LINE  | This file does not hold Indian constitutional-provision facts (for example, which Directive Principle or Article is said to reflect Gandhian ideals) or GS-IV Ethics case material; for those                                                    |

8 GS MAINS QUESTION ROUTES CARRIED BY THIS TOPIC

|                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>10-mark route</b><br>Distinguish democratic socialism from revolutionary socialism. Answer in 150 words                                   | <b>10-mark route</b><br>Why is anarchism a theory of non-coercive order rather than a defence of disorder? Answer in 150 words         |
| <b>10-mark route</b><br>Critically examine fascism as a political pathology rather than a coherent political philosophy. Answer in 150 words | <b>15-mark route</b><br>Evaluate Gandhi as a moral and decentralist anarchist. Answer in 250 words                                     |
| <b>15-mark route</b><br>Compare socialism, anarchism, Gandhism and fascism on liberty, equality, state and property. Answer in 250 words     | <b>15-mark route</b><br>Critically analyse conservatism as prudential reform rather than resistance to all change. Answer in 250 words |
| MECHANISM                                                                                                                                    | Directive fidelity, not content volume, decides the band a Mains answer lands in.                                                      |
| ANSWER LINE                                                                                                                                  | distrust of abstract design; preference for the known                                                                                  |

QUALIFIED VERDICT

This file does not hold Indian constitutional-provision facts (for example, which Directive Principle or Article is said to reflect Gandhian ideals) or GS-IV Ethics case material; for those. Use Political-Theory/00\_Master-Framework.md for the ideology matrix comparing socialism, fascism, anarchism and Gandhism. The examinable judgment is therefore graded rather than declarative: fix the boundary, carry the argument on named evidence, admit the strongest objection and state what survives it.